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Earthlights and unearthly visions

INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER

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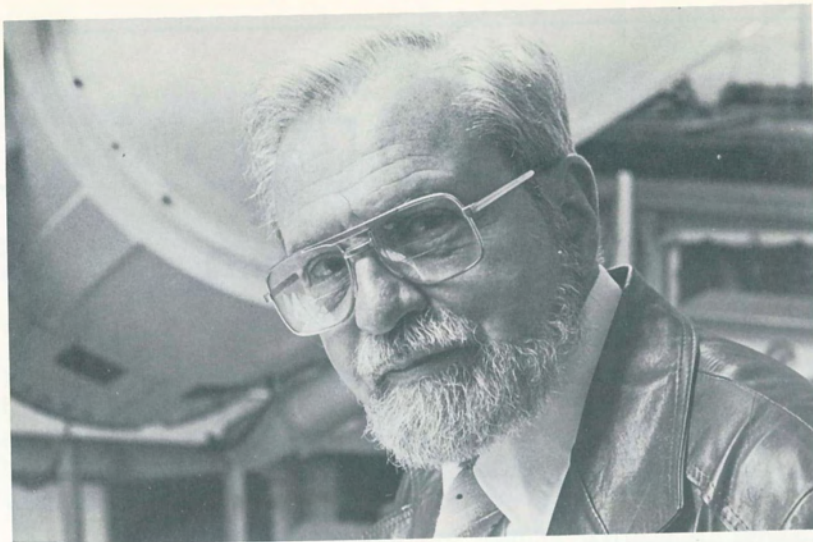
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Probabilities, of course, can never prove a thing. When, however, in the course of UFO investigations one encounters many cases, each having a fairly high possibility that a "genuinely new empirical observation" was involved, the probability that a new phenomenon was not observed becomes very small, and it gets smaller still as the number of cases increases.

J. Allen Hynek

Scientific Director,
Center for UFO Studies

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EDITORIAL

We're all right, John

"The Center for UFO Studies (CUFOS) is still in operation," John Schuessler writes in an article entitled "UFOLOGY: Situation Red?" in the January 1986 issue of the *MUFON UFO Journal*, "but seems to have fallen on hard times."

So begins the CUFOS section of a gloom-and-doom meditation on the state of what Schuessler insists on calling UFOLOGY. (We call it ufology here, John.) Schuessler thinks "UFOLOGY" is in bad shape -- as witness, he says, what's happening with CUFOS.

He informs us that "Dr. J. Allen Hynek, the driving force behind CUFOS, left the Illinois-based group to form a research center in Arizona But without Dr. Hynek . . . CUFOS will face a continued struggle for survival. CUFOS has dropped publication of the *CUFOS Associate Newsletter*, another sign of hard times"

Don't you believe it. In fact, as Schuessler should have known, Dr. Hynek is very much a part of CUFOS. True, he is no longer editor-in-chief of *IUR*. His resignation, for health reasons, was announced in the last issue (as was his complete disassociation from the ill-fated International Center for UFO Research), but he has expressed his approval of what we are doing with the publication and he remains CUFOS' scientific director -- a position he has no intention of relinquishing.

We ceased publication of the *CUFOS Associate Newsletter* -- and not long afterwards closed the Lima, Ohio, business office -- for reasons having nothing to do with "hard times." CUFOS was long overdue for reorganization and its directors, of whom I am one, agreed that an essential step in streamlining our operation was to run the show out of one office in the area (Chicago) where most of the officers live. John Timmerman, who edited the *Newsletter*,



Jerome Clark

expressed a desire to be rid of it and all of us felt it should be incorporated into an expanded *IUR* -- which is why this magazine now has 20, not 16, pages.

We are not rich -- what UFO organization is? -- but we're doing okay. We rent a pleasant office and we have one paid employee. We have a first-rate staff consisting of talented, dedicated individuals. CUFOS' chief executive officer Sherman J. Larsen, who has been here since the beginning (as cofounder, with Dr. Hynek, of CUFOS), says that in all his years he has never seen a better collection of people in the organization. The response to the new *IUR* has been overwhelmingly favorable and renewals and first-time subscriptions are coming in at a rate that pleases all of us.

In other words, we're all right, John. But please: next time you write about us, would it be too much to ask to give us a call first? -- Jerome Clark

Earthlights, earthquakes, UFOs and TST; or

who is Michael Persinger and why is he saying those things about me?

by Chris Rutkowski

Chris Rutkowski, who has a bachelor's degree in astronomy, is working on a master's degree in geophysics at the University of Manitoba. The editor of *Swamp Gas Journal*, he is chairman of Project UFO Canada and a member of the Folklore Studies Association. He lives in Winnipeg.

Over the years ufologists have sought to find a theory that would adequately explain all the reported characteristics of UFOs. The result has been a barrage of uninhibited speculation about everything from the extraterrestrial (ETH) to the hollow-earth "theory" to the equally extreme views of would-be debunkers who (often without adequate cause) invoke hallucinations and hoaxes. Some theories have incorporated other phenomena, including ghosts, Sasquatch and psychic phenomena, into their explanatory schemes.

But theories must be acceptable to the scientific community since, if they make no sense in terms of conventional science, the chances are great that they fail on several other grounds. This in no way suggests that conventional science must dictate the answers to all mysteries (in fact, that is simply not historically how science works); but a good theory draws on common sense and uses the scientific method.

These cautionary words are a necessary introduction to the subject I shall be discussing here, a relatively new UFO theory which is attracting considerable attention. This theory, called the TST (Tectonic Strain Theory), associates UFOs with recognized scientific phenomena, showing a relationship which implies a clear, natural cause for UFOs, not involving extraterrestrials or other supposed nonhuman intelligences. Instead, the TST says that UFOs are linked to the geology of the area over which the UFOs are reported seen. Because the TST is fairly complex, I shall describe its origin and development.

Most of us are familiar with a theory proposed by Philip J. Klass, who in *UFOs Identified* (1968) suggested that UFOs may be plasma, a sort of electronic discharge in compact form, very much

like what is reported of ball lightning. In fact, some scientists studying ball lightning even started including references to the UFO phenomenon in their writings because some UFOs appeared and behaved like ball lightning. Klass said it is possible that corona discharges near electrical transmission lines are being misidentified as UFOs.

Certainly in some cases UFO sightings could be traceable to such discharges and I can think of a few candidates in my files. But the theory failed to explain sightings far away from power lines and obviously could not account for many others. Similarly, ball lightning, which is rare, can occur only under certain circumstances; it too fails to account for many cases.

A number of years later the idea of a "plasma" as a UFO was to appear in a slightly different form, in a most unexpected way. It was on the controversial *Nova* television program on UFOs that I first heard of the TST. Immediately following the scenes depicting the Travis Walton abduction case, Dr. Michael Persinger of Laurentian University in Sudbury, Ontario, Canada, was interviewed. Persinger said that Walton had probably received a shock from a large plasma and that his "memory" of the abduction was due to the plasma's action of "shorting out" certain parts of his brain.

The scene then shifted to the U.S. Geological Survey laboratory of Dr. Brian Brady, who demonstrated that a rock sample crushed under high pressure produced minute bursts of light which looked like sparks but were said to be luminous bodies of energy resulting from the pressure itself. It was implied that UFOs very likely are large versions of these lights, on a larger scale because they are being produced in nature by huge underground rock formations under stress. Then the Val Johnson case was brought up and it was suggested that Johnson (the Minnesota law-enforcement officer who in August 1979 was physically injured and whose patrol car was damaged in an encounter with a bright UFO)

had been the victim of a plasma discharge caused by rock under stress.

Now this was something I knew about. I had investigated the Johnson case when it occurred and later I chaired a University of Manitoba panel which devoted a session to the incident, with Johnson as a guest. At no time was the plasma-discharge theory ever considered, although ball lightning was mentioned and dismissed on several grounds.

I got interested in the plasma theory, which I learned was called the TST. I called Brady in Colorado to get more information and was pleased to find him a pleasant fellow. He described some of his current experiments and, when asked whether the link to Persinger's theory was substantial, he replied that perhaps Persinger was stretching it a bit; they didn't really understand what was causing the observed effects. Then he said something that surprised me: that the results of the experiments had never been published. The full significance of this did not come to me, however, until much later.

I searched for some papers by Persinger and discovered that I already had several in my article collection. In a journal called *Perceptual & Motor Skills* he had been publishing a series titled "Geophysical Variables and Human Behavior." Persinger has a Ph.D. in physiological psychology from the University of Manitoba; his thesis concerned the effect of magnetic fields on small mammals. It is clear that he developed the TST as a natural outgrowth of his research, although the progression from laboratory magnetic fields to rock stress is not a simple one.

The TST is based on some rather major assumptions which in turn are based on not-very-well-understood natural phenomena. But at first glance, the TST seems established through statistics. Statistics, of course, are a powerful tool to the researcher and can be used to determine exactly how good a relationship is between several different events. They can, for example, tell us the percentage breakdown of religious belief in a particular neighborhood as well as any changes over time. They can tell us how many people changed to Republicans in the last election. But statistics cannot speak for themselves; they cannot tell us why two things are related or why things

are the way they are. These reasons are left to the scientist to discover.

In his articles on his research Persinger does little more than show some kind of relationship between UFOs and earthquakes. He also provides some data that seem to show a similar relationship between these results and such solar activity as sunspots and geomagnetic effects.

But the problem with TST is in the interpretation of these statistical results. The TST explains a report of a UFO, say a nocturnal light as the simplest example, in the following manner:

(1) Underground, rock is experiencing pressure from some form of tectonic activity (of the kind that is also responsible for earthquakes).

(2) Under this pressure the rock gives off electromagnetic radiation.

(3) This radiation travels to the surface of the earth and hovers over the ground.

(4) A witness sees the luminous ball of energy and reports a UFO sighting.

Persinger compares earthquakes with UFOs. In a particular area, for example the Uintah basin, he plots the locations and dates of earthquakes (or, more specifically, earth tremors) with those of UFO sightings; according to his statistical results, the two kinds of events tend to occur together in time and space.

But is this really so? Persinger found that the "best" results and correlations were produced when he introduced what he called a "lag" period of time ranging from a few days to six months and sometimes a year. Similarly, the locations were not always exactly the same for UFO reports and their corresponding earthquake. Some UFOs were seen hundreds of kilometers from the location of an earth tremor supposedly linked to the event. Essentially, in some cases we are to assume that a mild earth tremor, barely felt by anyone, was related to a UFO sighting that might have occurred several months earlier (or later) and several hundred kilometers away. This is entirely consistent with the TST, since it is the presence of a "strain field" that relates the two distinct events according to the theory.

But what, exactly, is a strain field? It is a volume of rock within which a pressure or strain is built up and from which an earthquake might eventually occur. We know that the earth's surface is constantly shifting due to the action of tectonic motion. The continents float like huge islands on the semifluid mantle and these continental plates, as they are called, collide with each other as they travel around the globe. This explains the large number of earthquakes in California, where the Pacific plate meets the American plate.

Apart from these large-scale movements, smaller, localized strains and tensions beneath the surface of the earth are possible and have been recorded with seismic instruments. As these strain fields are affected by shifting of the rock within the earth and they respond to the release and relaxation of stress, they will move in some complex manner. According to the TST, if a UFO is produced by a strain field and this field moves, the UFO will move with the strain field; if the strain field suddenly shifts quickly, the UFO could move at a high speed. Therefore, an observer might see a rapidly-moving light source which quickly zips out of sight, with no apparent explanation.

But geophysicists are certain only that the strain fields exist; there is no clear understanding of how large they are, how deep they might extend or whether they could move in the way described by the TST.

As for the energy contained in the strain field, it is possible to calculate the energy released in an earthquake or other seismic event. The conversion of this energy to light presents an interesting challenge. Scientists can detect pulses of electromagnetic radiation given off by rock under strain but the TST has these relatively small pulses travel from beneath the surface (where the strain fields are located) into the air and hover at a certain height above the terrain, radiating light to an observer. Although there is no evidence that this chain of events can occur in nature, nonetheless the TST's basic assumption is that this is what takes place.

On the other hand, earthquake lights have been observed and recorded on a number of occasions. They are typically hemispheres of diffuse light and appear near the epicenter of earthquakes, usually some of the larger

earthquakes, although there are spurious reports from much further from the epicenters on record. A modified version of the TST suggests that UFOs are small versions of earthquake lights associated with much smaller earth tremors and strains. John Derr, a noted geophysicist who has studied earthquake lights, says these earthquakes might be too small to detect: of the order of magnitudes of 1 or 2. But these faint movements are so slight that reputable methods for measuring them are not yet available. In other words, if you can't detect the strain release that created the UFO, how can you be sure that the strain was there at all?

Another subsection of the TST suggests that even if the radiation given off by an underground seismic event (which cannot be felt) does not become visible to the eye, it might directly affect a witness' brain, causing him to experience an observation of a nocturnal light or, conceivably, even a contact. It is therefore possible, by the TST, to explain the Hills' abduction as a vivid hallucination implanted in their brains by electromagnetic stimulation, all because of a strain within the rock over which they were driving. Even physical effects would be possible, since the energies involved could certainly create marks in the ground and on people's bodies. Persinger has written that most serious effects from a true "close encounter" with such radiation would be epileptic fits and, in the worst cases, death by electrocution.

All this could be true, however, only if the TST can be shown to have a viable mechanism in nature. Can such energy be produced and create these effects? No geophysicist with whom I have spoken thinks so. Does this mean it is not possible? No, not at all. If proper experiments can be conceived and performed to demonstrate these sequences of events, then the theory can be vindicated. Until then the theory fails to be anything other than pure speculation.

Ah, but what of the statistical results? What has been shown in all results so far is that some UFOs in certain areas are observed within several months of nearby earthquakes. One study in particular, relating UFOs and seismic events in the Uintah Basin, reported a high correlation between the two kinds of phenomena. But Persinger's UFO data came largely from the CUFOS UFOCAT and Allan Hendry has written

that the UFOCAT cannot be used for statistical studies because of problems with the data contained within it. One problem is that many of the reports are misidentifications of aircraft, balloons, stars and so on. That means Persinger found a relationship between people's mistaken conclusions about UFOs (really IFOs) and the earth tremors. To this criticism Persinger responds that, despite the inclusion of misidentifications, the "true" correlation came through anyway.

Another problem with the TST is evident when you consider other locations besides those selected by Persinger for the study. I chose Manitoba, with whose data I am most familiar. There are over 600 Manitoba UFO reports on file; yet no earthquakes have been recorded within its borders since records were first kept. There were a handful of earthquakes in North Dakota, Minnesota, Saskatchewan and northwestern Ontario, but none of these occurred in areas or at times near when UFOs were seen. Were undetectable earth tremors responsible for the UFOs or does the TST fail for Manitoba?

Responding to my published criticisms, which were offered in a constructive spirit, Persinger wrote a seven-page "Reply to Rutkowski" in *Perceptual & Motor Skills* (v. 60, 1985, pp. 575-582). He begins by saying that I criticized the TST "on the basis of its apparent lack of intuitive appeal, questionable data base and the requirement for multivariate statistical techniques." He goes on to assert that if my "criteria were applied to any other new idea of research, progress would be stifled from the outset." He also claims that the basis for the TST "is well documented by empirical analyses," then as references cites himself five times.

But his studies were correlational, not empirical, and there are no other empirical studies to support the TST. As for my stifling of progress, scientific theories always undergo a series of critical evaluations and rethinking before they are fully accepted by the scientific community. I suggest that it is much more unusual for the TST to have circulated for 10 years before someone (namely me) pointed out some problems with it.

One person who has given the TST some notice has been Paul Devereux, whose book *Earth Lights* (1982) and his subsequent publication of articles in *New Scientist* detailing the work of the

Dragon Project have received a great deal of attention overseas. In his book he cites Persinger's research to support his premise that UFO reports are similarly linked to tectonic events in Britain. Stanton Friedman, however, has pointed out that, in one instance where Devereux found a correlation between a number of UFO reports and a regional fault in the earth's surface, he neglected to add that a road runs near the fault line and that UFO reports might be expected to come from travelers on the road.

This is essentially one of my major objections to the TST as well. If a UFO is seen within a large area (say 2500 square kilometers) and given a sufficient period of time, during which an earth tremor occurs somewhere in the region, then why could there not be some other variable event much closer to the time and location of the observed UFO -- an event that might explain it much better?

Devereux saw a critical article I wrote for the *CUFOS Associate Newsletter* in 1984 and sent an angry letter to CUFOS, complaining that he resented being "lumped" in with Persinger even as he defended the TST. He maintains that the TST is the "strongest and most productive line of ufological enquiry in a decade or more." He briefly describes his (unpublished) replications of Brian Brady's rock-crushing experiments. Calling my presentation of the TST "misleading," he says I am "inaccurate, incorrect and ill-informed." This despite the fact that Devereux himself points out problems with Persinger's studies in some of his writings -- which is all I am trying to do.

One other suggestion made to me by a ufologist concerns the problem of earthquakes themselves. If UFOs are linked mechanically to the seismic actions of earth tremors, why do we not have UFO reports each time we have an earth tremor? Saying that the "conditions might not have been right" is not an answer, just a hand-waving argument.

In summary, while the TST is acceptable as a theory, the mechanisms it uses to explain UFOs as natural events are not established. The physics of producing underground electromagnetic energy, converting it to light and sustaining it above the ground for some period of time is simply far too complex and involves such tenuous assumptions that it cannot be accepted without a great many

misgivings. In the future it is possible that the TST may be revised and rethought to overcome the problems it faces. I hope to try to work out some solutions myself. But so far all we have

seen is an attempt to explain an unknown phenomenon with another equally unpredictable, equally unknown phenomenon. ❖

Announcement

From the CUFOS Board

CUFOS Board of Directors has announced that *IUR* will accept advertising. The following schedule was adopted at the March 1, Board meeting:

Space	Length	Width	Times per year/cost		
			1	3	6
Full page	9 1/2"	7"	\$120	\$110	\$103
1/2 page	9 1/2"	3 3/8"	72	66	62
1/4 page	4 5/8"	3 3/8"	48	44	41
1/6 page	3"	3 3/8"	30	27	25

CUFOS is also offering a special position on its back cover at the following rates:

Space	Length	Width	Cost
Full page	9 1/2"	7"	\$142
1/2 page	9 1/2"	3 3/8"	85

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The publisher assumes no responsibility if, for any reason, it becomes necessary to omit an advertisement.

The North West Cape incident:

UFOs and nuclear alert in Australia

by Bill Chalker

Bill Chalker, chemist by vocation, ufologist by avocation, has conducted an extensive investigation into the Australian government's involvement with the UFO phenomenon.

Science is often defined as the ordered arrangement of ascertained knowledge, including the methods by which such knowledge is extended and the criteria by which its truth is tested. This narrow definition of science permits us to embrace the clandestine world of intelligence. It is a branch of science to which few of us are privy.

Today's world of intelligence is mind-boggling. One of the biggest and most secretive organizations is the National Security Agency (NSA), its initials often seen as meaning "No Such Agency" or "Never Say Anything." Its operations are massive and perhaps not a little disturbing in their scope. Some of these operations have been described in a fascinating book by James Bamford, *The Puzzle Palace* (1982). The so-called Ears of America exist as "the world's most secret espionage system."

Therefore, considerable interest was generated when a U.S. District Court ruled that the NSA did not have to accede to a Freedom of Information Act (FOIA) request to supply a civilian group, Citizens Against UFO Secrecy (CAUS), with hundreds of UFO documents in its possession.

The extraordinary ruling stated that the release of the documents "could seriously jeopardize the work of the agency and the security of the United States." With regard to the balance between public interest about UFOs and the NSA's need for secrecy, the court further ruled that "public interest in disclosure is far outweighed by the sensitive nature of the materials and the obvious effect on national security their release may well entail."

One wonders what can be made of the 21-page IN CAMERA affidavit presented by Eugene F. Yeates, Chief of the Office of Policy of the NSA, to the District of Columbia Court. This was all

the judge had access to in making his decision to deny access to the NSA UFO documents. He was never made privy to the original documents.

The affidavit itself was classified "TOP SECRET _____" -- "TOP SECRET UMBRA," I assume -- meaning that the information was of the highest SIGINT (Signals Intelligence) sensitivity; however, a heavily-censored copy was subsequently released.

The NSA indicated disclosure of its UFO documents would have the following effect: "When alerted to the extent of NSA's capability, and if given information from which inferences could be drawn as to the processing methods used, foreign intelligence services would be able to evade or defeat portions of NSA's present foreign intelligence efforts."

The affidavit further stated:

I have determined that the 156

_____ reports relating to COMINT [Communications Intelligence] activities at issue here are based on intercepted communications of foreign governments of SIGINT operations and, thus, remain properly classified. In conducting this review I have weighed the significant need for openness in government against the likelihood of damage to our national security at this time and have determined that each record should continue to be classified. No meaningful portion can be segregated from the records without revealing classified information about the intercepted communications underlying the COMINT reports. . . .

I certify that disclosure of past and foreign intelligence communications activities of NSA revealed in the records the plaintiff [CAUS] seeks would endanger highly valuable sources of foreign intelligence.

As the current military and political situation requires such clandestine intelligence activity to maintain the integrity of our national security, it is difficult to argue against the cogency of the judge's remarks. All of us value our free and democratic political systems. Yet, since the UFO phenomenon seems global in scope, overshadowing current political and military arrangements,

perhaps there is justification for independent reviews of the NSA data by parties acceptable to both the NSA and the UFO-research community. Surely at least the judge should have been made privy to the original documents rather than an NSA-prepared summary.

Lawrence Fawcett and Barry J. Greenwood, authors of *Clear Intent* (1984), refer to one data cited in the "TOP SECRET _____" affidavit but could offer no suggestion as to what event it was referring to. For me, however, this section was extremely meaningful. The relevant page, heavily censored, tells us this much:

9. (TS _____) [1] NSA-originated reports. Thirty-eight documents are the direct product of NSA SIGINT operations and one document describes classified SIGINT activities. These documents can be further described as follows:

b. One record is a 1973 report which _____.[2].

This reference made me rethink the significance of a specific UFO report contained in the Royal Air Force (RAAF) files. I acquired this report long before I was afforded the first civilian direct access to the totality of the RAAF UFO files during 1982.

When I first saw the report back in about 1975, I was surprised, considering its contents, that, first, it had been entered onto a standard RAAF-Department of Defense Sighting Report Form and that, second, it has been made available to a researcher closely associated with me at that time. Knowing now its broader implications, which I am about to reveal, I am incredulous that people outside the world of military intelligence were made privy to it. But I am heartened that it did see the light of day and now its fuller implications are to be laid bare for public debate and scrutiny. This is as it should have been all along.

The case in question involved two U.S. Naval (USN) personnel who observed a UFO near the restricted USN Communications stations at North West Cape in Western Australia.

At about 1915 hours, on Thursday, October 25, 1973, Lt. Comdr. M. (USN) saw "a large black, airborne object" at a distance of approximately

five miles to the west at an altitude estimated at 2,000 feet. Lt. Cmdr. M. was driving south from the NAVCOMSTA (Naval Communication Station) toward the support township of Exmouth, along Murat Road. As the officer reported in a written statement, "After about 20-25 seconds the craft accelerated at unbelievable speed and disappeared to the north." The officer's report further states:

7. Hovering at first, then accelerating beyond belief . . .

9. no noise or exhaust . . .

11. have never experienced anything like it.

The other witness, Fire Capt. (USN) Bill L., provided the following narrative:

At 1920 hrs. I was called by the P.O.W. to close the Officers club. I proceeded towards the club in the Fire Dept. pick-up 488, when my attention was drawn to a large black object, which at first I took to be a small cloud formation, due west of Area "B" [Area "B" is the location of the High Frequency Transmitter and between two to three miles due west of this point is located Mount Athol]. While traveling towards the Officers club I couldn't help but be attracted by this object's appearance. On alighting from pick-up 488, I stood for several minutes and watched this black sphere hovering. The sky was clear and pale green-blue. No clouds were about whatsoever. The object was completely stationary except for a halo around the center, which appeared to be either revolving or pulsating. After watching it for approximately 4 minutes, it suddenly took off at tremendous speed and disappeared in a northerly direction, in a few seconds. I consider this object to have been approximately 30 feet in diameter, hovering at 1,000 feet over the hills due west of the base. It was black, maybe due to looking in the direction of the setting sun. No lights appeared on it at any time.

The real significance of this provocative report has to do with two things: one, its location, obviously, and, two, the date of occurrence: October 25, 1973. Consider this:

In *A Suitable Piece of Real Estate: American Installations in Australia* (1980) Dr. Desmond Ball, Senior Research Fellow in the Strategic and Defense Studies Center at the Australian National University, writes: "The NSA is the principal U.S. intelligence agency operating in Australia . . . Compared to the CIA in Australia, the NSA has a much larger presence, is more important, more secret, and closer to Australia's own intelligence organizations." It is responsible for all "the various activities associated with Signals Intelligence -- electronic intelligence,

communications intelligence, radar intelligence, electronic counter intelligence and signal security."

The NSA operates at the North West Cape base, through its Naval Security Group component. The base, along with other American bases at other locations in Australia, has long been a matter of acute political sensitivity, related to concern that such sites would be nuclear targets during a major outbreak of hostilities between the superpowers.

On October 11, 1973, five days after the Middle East (Yom Kippur) War broke out, North West Cape and other U.S. bases in Australia were put on full alert.

According to Richard Hall, author of *The Secret State* (1978), this alert status was to escalate dramatically because of an "NSA misreading of Arabic in a Syrian message to the USSR which led Kissinger and Nixon to believe that Soviet troops might be sent to the Middle East."

Consequently, two weeks after the October 11 alert, North West Cape was used to communicate the general U.S. alert to both conventional and nuclear forces in the region -- all of this, according to Dr. Ball, without the Australian government's being informed. The date: October 25, 1973!

So there we have it. On the same day the North West Cape facility is communicating a full nuclear alert to the region, based on NSA COMINT interceptions, a startling UFO sighting is made by base personnel. It therefore seems likely that this is the "1973 report" referred to in the top secret NSA affidavit. I wonder what the Australian government made of this extraordinary "coincidence" when it was finally informed that a full nuclear alert had emanated from Australian soil without its knowledge on October 25, 1973. Perhaps, as it appears, the UFO sighting may have been reported in isolation, with no communications being made. Even this situation would be cause for concern.

The military has always viewed provocative UFO events in isolation against the backdrop of local events. But in the case of the North West Cape sighting, it should be noted that by October 1973 the United States itself was

caught up in a massive UFO wave. Much of the publicity revolved around a bizarre CE3 involving two Mississippi fishermen across from local Naval shipyards at which nuclear submarines were under construction. This event occurred on October 11, 1973 -- by coincidence the date of the initial full alert.

There are clear lessons for Australia's own "official, governmental examiner" of UFO reports, namely the RAAF, and for other Australian agencies that have flirted with the subject over the years. The latter include the Department of Civil Aviation (now Department of Transport), the Joint Intelligence Organization (JIO, formerly JIB, the Joint Intelligence Bureau), the Australian Security and Intelligence Organization (ASIO) and the Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organization (CSIRO).

On May 2, 1984, the RAAF curtailed its long public flirtation with the UFO controversy. In announcing the RAAF's "new" policy on UFOs, Minister of Defense Gordon Scholes stated, "The RAAF in future will investigate fully only those Unusual Aerial Sightings which suggest a defense or national security implication." He went on to say, "The vast majority of reports submitted by the public have proved not to have a national security significance."

The "policy change" was in fact an inevitable expression of the RAAF's long involvement in the Australian UFO controversy. The whole history of the RAAF's activity in this area has been based on two criteria: logically, national security and, predictably, political expediency.

The RAAF has stated that "nothing that has arisen from the three or four percent of unexplained cases" -- the figure is actually now closer to an eight-percent average over the last 20 years, according to the RAAF's own statistics, and has gone as high as 33 percent in a single year -- "gives any firm support for the belief that interlopers from other places in this world or outside it have been visiting us."

After examining many of those officially unexplained cases (and many of the "explained" ones as well), I have found that surprisingly many of them contain extraordinary details which do not lend themselves to easy explanation.

In the great majority of cases that make up this unexplained residue, national security implications were not so clearly apparent as in the North West Cape event. It would be wrong, however, to assume that sighting was unique.

Consider, for example, this account from a former RAF corporal stationed at Maralinga -- site of the British nuclear tests in Australia -- during October and November 1957. The incident was absent from the official RAAF files. During September and October 1957 the nuclear-weapons test series codenamed ANTLER were undertaken at Maralinga with kiloton-range nuclear explosions occurring on September 25 and October 9. The site was subject to intense security, however, during October and November 1957, when the integrity of the facility was challenged in an extraordinary fashion.

Just before dusk one evening the RAF corporal and some colleagues were called out of the Maralinga village canteen to witness a UFO hovering, apparently silently, over the airfield. It was described as a "magnificent sight," being silver-blue in color, of a metallic luster, with a line of "windows" or "portholes" along its edge. The corporal states that the object could be seen so clearly that he and his companions could make out what appeared to be plating on its surface. The air traffic control officer on duty also supposedly witnessed the spectacle. He allegedly checked Alice Springs and Edinburgh airfields, which reported that they did not have anything over their areas. No photographs were taken, purportedly because the top security status of the area required that all cameras be locked away. These had to be signed in and out when used. After about 15 minutes the aerial object left, swiftly and silently, as dusk began to fall.

The witness told Jenny Randles, "I swear to you as a practicing Christian this was no dream, no illusion, no fairy story -- but a solid craft of metallic construction."

It seems to me that it is unwise -- or at least premature -- to dismiss UFO sightings as having no "national security significance" and no scientific relevance. The time for secrecy and apathy has passed. The time for open public study and substantial scientific investigation has come.

References

1. "(TS_____)" -- TSU? -- means the whole section is classified TOP SECRET (UMBRA?).
2. The rest of the five-line paragraph is censored. Section 9.a. is 20 lines long. Only one line is uncensored. ❧

1986 CUFOS Board/Officer elections...

At the March 1, 1986 Board meeting, CUFOS had its annual election of Directors and Officers.

The 1986 Board of Directors:

Mark Chesney
Jerome Clark
Nancy Conrad
George Eberhart
Sherman J. Larsen
Fred Merritt
Mark Rodeghier
Don Schmitt
John P. Timmerman

Officers elected for 1986:

President and Chief Executive Officer:
Sherman J. Larsen
Vice President: Mark Rodeghier
Vice President: Jerome Clark
Vice President, Public Relations: John P. Timmerman
Treasurer: Nancy Conrad
Secretary: Fred Merritt

Advisory Panel:

J. Allen Hynek
Mimi Hynek
Erwin Polakoff

The use and abuse of hypnosis in UFO investigation

by Hobart Gregory Baker

Hobart Gregory Baker is a science writer and editor for the American Chemical Society in Columbus, Ohio. He has a particular interest in the psychological aspects of the UFO problem, especially the accuracy of witness testimony and the factors that affect perception and testimony. He directs the Center for Identified Flying Objects.

Hypnosis is a state of enhanced suggestibility (1). It is frequently used by law enforcement personnel as a tool to investigate crimes and accidents. Its use as an investigative tool has spread to nonlegal situations, and in 1963 it was used to investigate the sighting of a UFO by Barney and Betty Hill (2). Hypnosis' use as an investigative tool stems from the belief that it enhances recall.

Since the mid-1970's, there has been an explosive increase in the use of hypnosis by law enforcement agencies and UFO investigators. This has occurred despite the dangers and limitations of hypnosis and the warnings of critics. It is known that people can fake hypnosis and lie in the hypnotic state (3), that hypnosis enhances the amount of distortion triggered by leading questions (4), that hypnosis causes pseudomemories (3), and that hypnosis enhances a witness' confidence in his or her testimony, even though the testimony may be inaccurate (4). Furthermore, hypnosis triggers fantasies (4). Several studies indicate that hypnosis does not enhance recall and that testimony revealed with the aid of hypnosis is quite inaccurate (5, 6).

Although it has been argued that the patterns in the hypnotically-elicited testimony of UFO observers indicate that such testimony is accurate and based on objective reality, this argument fails to consider the historical misuses of hypnosis by UFO investigators and the importance of demand characteristics, the Clever Hans effect, leading questions and misleading statements, prehypnosis discussions, nonverbal cues, coincidence, and the role of books, movies, and the mass media on the formation of patterns. Hypnosis' misuse has

occurred largely because of ignorance of its limitations and the lack of guidelines. In this paper, I present guidelines and recommendations for the use of hypnosis in the investigation of UFO reports.

The prehypnotic investigation

After a UFO sighting has been reported and it is judged worthy of investigation, the witness should be interviewed. The investigator must never unnecessarily talk about UFOs with the witness during the investigation, since such discussions distort memory and fuel hypnotically-induced fantasies. Initially, the witness should be told to write down everything remembered about the sighting. The investigator should not ask questions at this time since "free reports are consistently more accurate but less complete than reports obtained through specifically directed inquiry," according to Drs. Hilgard and Loftus (7).

After everything remembered is written down, the investigator can ask (or give in written form) specific but nonleading questions about the sighting. It is important that nonleading questions be asked since "the wording of questions put to a witness can distort the witness' memory for the previously experienced event" (7). During this part of the investigation, the UFO witness should be questioned about what he or she knew about UFOs prior to the sighting and what books and magazine, newspaper, radio and television stories and programs about UFOs have been read and heard, since information from such items is often used to construct fantasies during hypnosis.

Using the information given by the witness, the investigator must now try to identify the object or phenomenon that was reported to be a UFO. This is done by consulting astronomy records, airports, companies that use airplanes and so on. If the reported object or phenomenon is still unidentified, the investigation should continue.

continued

The hypnotic investigation

At some point hypnosis may be considered effective in generating more leads. With luck these leads will point to evidence that allows the investigator to solve the riddle. It must always be kept in mind that hypnosis is to be used only to obtain leads in the investigative situation. Under no circumstances should testimony obtained with the aid of hypnosis be taken at face value.

Once it is decided that hypnosis is to be used to interview the witness, discussions about UFOs must be kept to a minimum. Orne states that "inadvertent comments made during prior interrogation or in discussion with others who might have knowledge will become incorporated and form the basis of any pseudomemories" (3). Even if hypnosis is not contemplated, it is best never to unnecessarily discuss UFOs with the witnesses, since a witness' memories of UFO events are easily distorted.

The investigator should introduce the UFO witness to the hypnotist and everything hereafter should be audiotaped (8). I strongly urge videotaping of hypnosis sessions, since videotapes reveal nonverbal cues. Nonverbal cues are extremely important in hypnosis because hypnotized people are "highly motivated to please others, most especially the hypnotist and those who are seen as associated with the hypnotist.... it is all too easy for observers inadvertently to communicate to the subject what they expect, what they are startled by, or what they are disappointed by" (9), according to Dr. Eugene Levitt, a psychologist and hypnosis expert. For this reason, no one should observe the hypnosis session, since observers can inadvertently cue the subject.

The hypnotist should be a physician or psychologist who is experienced in the use of hypnosis (3). Under no circumstances should a lay hypnotist be used or should rapport be transferred to a layman. Also, the hypnotist must have no vested interest in the case (10). It is important for the hypnotist to know as little as possible about UFOs, and this includes the UFO case he or she is working on. This is important because "if the hypnotist has beliefs about what actually occurred, it is exceedingly difficult for him to prevent himself from inadvertently guiding the subject's recall so that he will eventually

'remember' what he, the hypnotist, believes actually happened" (3). What few facts the hypnotist needs to know should be given to the hypnotist in written form only (10). Also, the hypnotist must try to remain calm and try not to express any kind of emotion during the hypnosis session.

Before the hypnotic induction the hypnotist should dispell some of the misconceptions and myths about hypnosis. These false beliefs include the lie-detector nature of hypnosis and the belief that the hypnotist can control the subject (11). To relax the witness, the hypnotist should talk about the weather, sports, hobbies and so forth (11).

The witness must be hypnotized voluntarily (12), and after trance induction, a test for the hypnotic trance should be conducted, since people can easily fake hypnosis. Mutter tests for the trance by suggesting to the subject that the subject's hand is anesthetized (10). After this suggestion is given, a hemostat is applied to the hand. He states that "it is extremely difficult for a simulator [faker] to tolerate this test because of the degree of discomfort evoked by this stimulus" (10).

Memory can be "refreshed" by hypnosis in several ways. One way is to hypnotize the UFO witness and simply ask what is remembered about the UFO sighting. A second way, frequently used in the context of UFO investigations, is hypnotic age regression. In hypnotic age regression the witness is hypnotized and regressed in age or time to the moment of the UFO sighting. When told to do so, the witness "relives" the events of the UFO sighting as if they were occurring in the present. A third method sometimes used to enhance recall is the giving of a posthypnotic suggestion to remember. A person under a posthypnotic suggestion is really functioning under hypnosis. The hypnotist must decide which method is appropriate for the UFO witness at hand. All three techniques are affected by the same factors. Hence, the safeguards presented in this paper are applicable to all three methods.

After hypnotic induction, the subject should be told to freely recall everything remembered about the UFO sighting. The hypnotist must not ask questions at this time but instead should allow the witness freely to describe the UFO encounter.

As Hilgard and Loftus note, "questions not only elicit information from a witness but they also supply information to the witness" (7).

The UFO witness may occasionally pause in the giving of his or her story. The hypnotist must not force the subject to continue. Instead, the hypnotist should mildly prompt the witness to continue by saying, "Go on," "Continue," or "Uh-huh." The hypnotist must only mildly prompt the subject since, as Levitt states, "most hypnotized individuals are more easily influenced than when they are in the waking or nonhypnotic state.... Any tactic adopted ... in an obvious effort to improve the witness' memory strongly implies dissatisfaction with the response or responses that have already been given" (9). Thus, if the hypnotist seems highly interested in the subject's responses, such as by saying "Really?" or "Very interesting; tell me more," the subject will continue to tell the story, perhaps a fantasized story, in order to please the hypnotist. Likewise, if the hypnotist seems displeased, the subject will likely invent a story that pleases the hypnotist. Similarly, the showing of photographs or drawings of UFOs or alleged UFO "critters" to the subject, particularly during hypnosis, is highly leading.

After the hypnotized UFO witness freely gives his or her story, short, nonleading questions should be asked to collect more information. Of course, the hypnotist must not force the subject to answer these questions. Before questions are asked, the witness should be told to say his or her first thoughts when questioned and that it is okay to know the answers to questions (10). Also, in formulating the questions, the hypnotist must remember that he or she can easily be led astray, since the witness' "recollections" may be total fantasy.

Some of the UFO stories revealed by hypnosis may be cryptomnesic fantasies, which are fantasies unknowingly derived from books, newspapers, magazines, movies, television and radio broadcasts, discussions and so on. Because of the existence of these fantasies, it is important for the investigator to inquire about the witness' exposure to such items and discussions. One technique has had limited success at revealing whether or not a story revealed by hypnosis is a cryptomnesic fantasy. The hypnotized subject is simply asked by the hypnotist something like

"Where did you get this story?" Sometimes subjects will reveal their sources, which can be checked.

Before terminating hypnosis, the UFO witness should be asked for permission to have the testimony remembered. If traumatic information is revealed by hypnosis, the hypnotist should say something like "You will remember what you want to remember" (10). Many times in UFO investigations, however, more than one hypnosis session is required for the complete UFO story. Any time more than one hypnosis session is conducted, the number of factors tainting memory is increased. Furthermore, the need for multiple sessions with the same subject strongly suggests that the subject's testimony is greatly contaminated with fantasy.

If more than one hypnosis session is conducted with the same subject, the subject must be given a posthypnotic suggestion to forget everything that occurred and was said during hypnosis. Such suggestion must be given during each session if multiple sessions are anticipated. If such suggestions are not given, the witness can remember and talk about what was said during hypnosis, and this can distort memory and future testimony. Furthermore, the hypnotist and UFO investigator must not talk about UFOs with the witness between hypnosis sessions. Also, the time interval between sessions should be minimal.

The posthypnotic investigation

After the hypnosis session is terminated, a state of high suggestibility lingers with the subject. Thus, testimony obtained immediately after the termination of hypnosis may be distorted and tainted. For this reason, no discussions about UFOs should be conducted with the witness immediately after the termination of hypnosis. Also, information revealed because of a posthypnotic suggestion need not be any more reliable than testimony revealed by other means since, as I have previously stated, it is a form of hypnosis and is affected by a host of factors.

After the investigation is complete, a report should be written. The report must detail all discussions that occurred immediately before, during, and after hypnosis, questions asked by the hypnotist, why the subject was hypnotized, whether the UFO witness was exposed to UFO literature and discussions prior to hypnosis and,

of course, the testimony that was revealed with the aid of hypnosis. The hypnotist's questions and the witness' testimony must be quoted, and this information must be in chronological order.

The guidelines in this paper, if followed, will eliminate and define many of the factors that distort testimony that is collected with hypnosis. But it must be remembered that such testimony can never be free of contamination. Hypnosis is not a lie detector and it cannot produce totally accurate testimony; testimony induced by hypnosis must never be taken at face value. The testimony must be verified, and just because some of the testimony is verified, it does not follow that all of the testimony is accurate. In general, testimony about a UFO is verified when unquestionable physical evidence is found and is available for study by scientists.

I believe that the use of hypnosis to investigate UFO reports should be avoided due to the controversy surrounding the validity of testimony induced by hypnosis and recent studies that suggest such testimony is less accurate than waking testimony. If hypnosis is used to investigate UFO reports, it should be used only as a last resort and with adequate safeguards. Tables 1 and 2 summarize the more salient safeguards presented in this paper. Furthermore, before hypnosis is considered, the hypnotist and UFO investigator should contemplate the consequences of the misuses of the results of their hypnotic investigations by persons who do not know the limitations of hypnosis. As Hibler warns, "Hypnosis can make no promises other than to confuse, mislead, and misdirect resources if it is not carefully applied" (13). He further cautions that "hypnosis ought to be reserved for those limited but well-defined circumstances in which little is left to chance. Otherwise, it may be more noble not to hypnotize at all."

TABLE 1. *Summary of mandatory safeguards to be used before, during, and after hypnosis.*

No unnecessary discussions are to be conducted with the UFO witness before, during, or after hypnosis.

The UFO witness must be asked what UFO literature he or she has read and what UFO movies/television programs have been watched.

Hypnosis should be used only to gather leads.

All information revealed by hypnosis must be verified.

The UFO witness must be hypnotized voluntarily.

The hypnosis session must be audiotaped.

A test for faking must be conducted.

No observers are allowed to be with subject and hypnotist.

The hypnotist should be a psychologist or physician, preferably psychiatrist, experienced in the use of hypnosis.

The hypnotist must have no vested interest in the UFO case.

The hypnotist should know almost nothing about UFOs.

No leading statements can be made during hypnosis.

No leading questions can be asked at any time, especially during hypnosis.

Questions can be asked during hypnosis only after the witness has been given time to freely describe the UFO event.

The hypnotist must only mildly prompt the witness to continue to tell the story.

If more than one hypnosis session is given, a posthypnotic suggestion to forget what happened during hypnosis must be given.

If more than one hypnosis session is given, no discussions about UFOs can be conducted between hypnosis sessions.

The hypnotist should try not to express emotion and must minimize all cueing.

There must be no immediate posthypnosis talks.

The report of the investigation must be very detailed, with numerous contextual quotes.

TABLE 2. *Summary of safeguards for hypnosis that are highly recommended.*

The hypnosis session should be videotaped.

There should be only one hypnosis session with the same subject.

Any information that the hypnotist needs to know should be given to the hypnotist in writing.

The hypnotist should dispell some of the misconceptions about hypnosis before the subject is hypnotized.

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Publications of note

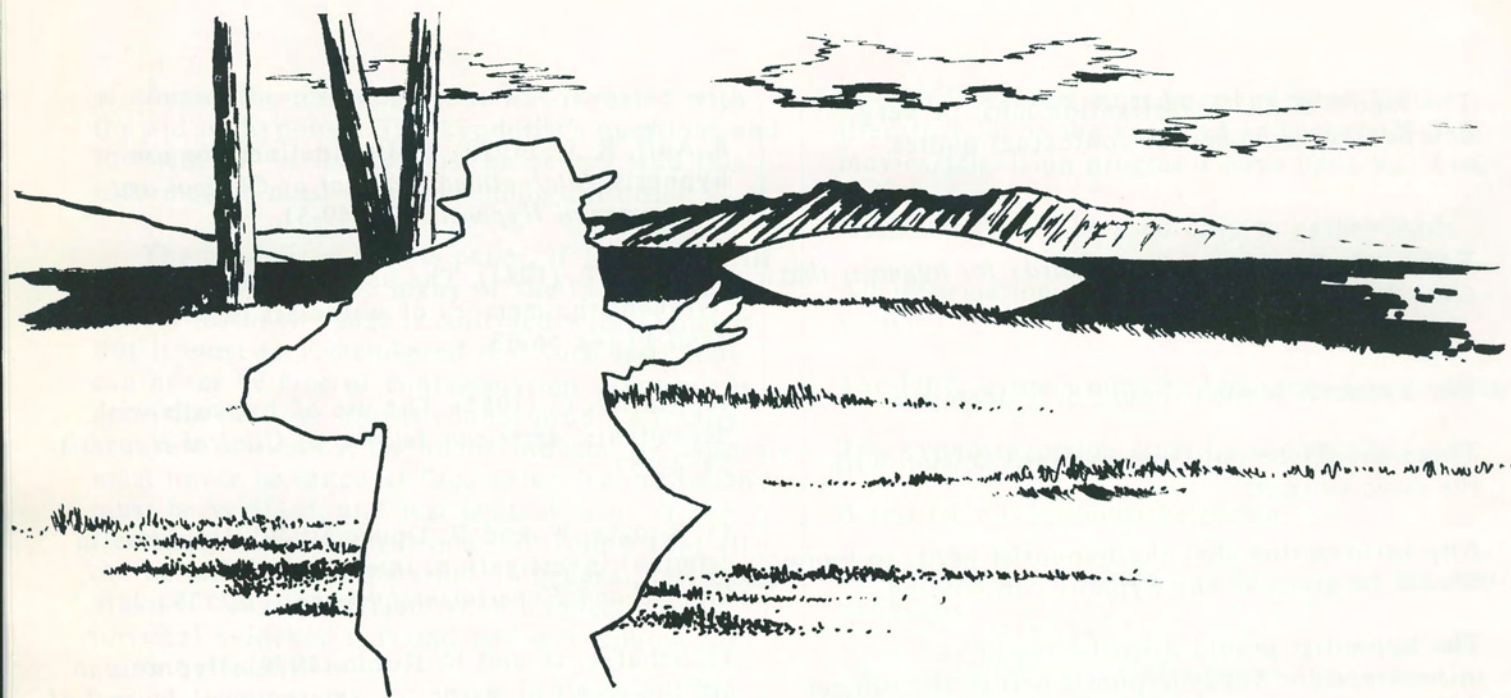
CUFOS has copies of the three issues published to date of the *Journal of UFO Studies*. If you would like the tables of contents to these issues, please send a #10 business envelope, stamped and self-addressed, to CUFOS, 1955 John's Drive, Glenview, Illinois 60025-1615.

Coming soon in IUR...

Does ufology have a future?
by David M. Jacobs

Soviet UFO spectacular,
by Richard Hall

UFOs -- a question of reality,
by Jenny Randles



The curious case of the Argentine crashed saucer

by Willy Smith

Willy Smith, a physicist who lives in Florida, devotes full time to UFO research. He is an *IUR* contributing editor.

Almost all crashed-disc stories have involved events that allegedly occurred in the United States. One notable exception is an Argentine report from the early 1950s. The story goes like this:

On May 10, 1950, while driving in an isolated region of Argentina, Enrique Bossa (or Enrico Botta, or Enrico Carotenuto Botta) came across a disc-shaped craft resting not far from the highway. The witness climbed inside where he found three small dead humanoids. He departed, drove back to his hotel and the next day returned with two friends, only to discover that the craft was now a pile of ashes. But they observed two other UFOs circling overhead and Bossa managed to obtain two photographs. (1)

Numerous references for this case exist but all are based on original letters the alleged witness wrote. We will draw upon two versions in this article:

(i) The version provided by Coral Lorenzen, dating from the spring of 1955 (2). This version is apparently based on a first account appearing in *El Universal* of Caracas, Venezuela, on May 7, 1955.

(ii) A straight translation into French of a letter by Enrique Bossa, published in a Swiss magazine. (3) This second version, dated November 1, 1955, is more detailed and embellished than the first.

Each narrative contains internal contradictions and, moreover, there are some interesting discrepancies between them:

(a) In version ii Bossa indicates that at the time he was "living in the city of Bahia Blanca, capital of the province of La Pampa." The city of Bahia Blanca is in the province of Buenos Aires and of course it is not the capital of La Pampa. It is inconceivable that an educated person alleging to have lived in the area for several months could make such an error.

(b) The lighting inside the craft was dim and Bossa could not determine the color of the eyes of the crew (version i). Yet Bossa kept his green-tinted glasses on! In version ii the glasses are not mentioned.

(c) In version i Bossa found the object at a distance of 75 kilometers from "his hotel," while in version ii he was either 280 kilometers from Bahia Blanca (province of Buenos Aires) or 200 kilometers from the city of General Acha (province of La Pampa). He also established his geographical coordinates as 68 degrees west and 37 degrees south. All of this information is inconsistent.

(d) No time is given for the encounter, although Bossa is careful to provide the time of his departure (apparently from General Acha) with two friends the next day. In version ii they started at dawn; in version i rain prevented them from departing until afternoon.

(e) The names of the friends are not provided. In fact, when one thinks about it, we know of Bossa and his personality only through the letters he wrote and the information provided by Horacio Gonzalez, a Venezuelan ufologist now deceased. Coral Lorenzen indicates that she talked with Bossa by phone in 1957 and Len Stringfield may have a third letter from him, obtained through the good services of Horacio Gonzalez (1, page 84) and "written in wretched English." Bossa is variously described as an architect, an aeronautical engineer or an architectural engineer (whatever that may be).

(f) A minor inconsistency between the two versions is the reported difficulty Bossa experienced when trying to start his car on the run. No such problem is mentioned in version i. A second minor discrepancy concerns the dates. According to version ii, the incident took place on May 15, 1955, while in other versions, including a letter written to Stringfield (1, page 82) on October 25, 1955, the date is reported to be May 10, 1955.

(g) Last but not least are the behavioral inconsistencies: If we believe what we are told, Bossa, an educated man, kept his cool while inside the craft, where he remained about five minutes. Yet, presented with the opportunity to remove some item from what he had recognized as a

spaceship, he did nothing of the kind! Also, while first approaching the landed craft (notice, it was not demolished), he tells us that when he was at a distance of 50 meters he thought it was a plane that had crashed. He then proceeds to describe the saucer in terms entirely incompatible with the way a crashed plane would look. In version i Bossa had no problems entering the craft; in version ii he had to do some acrobatics to accomplish it.

It is rather hard to believe that, knowing what was waiting in the fields, he opted not to return immediately. This site was adjacent to the road and even if the area is thinly populated, it is unlikely that no one would pass the place for many hours. If we take Bossa's account seriously, we have to conclude that the bodies, described as stone cold, may have lain there undisturbed for as long as a day.

In the end there are only two possibilities:

(i) The story is true, in which case it becomes necessary to find a satisfactory explanation for the anomalies listed above.

(ii) The whole thing is a clever hoax, perhaps developed by an educated man for his own entertainment or by a not-so-well-educated man for financial gain, in which case Bossa perhaps never existed.

If he was as well known as Gonzalez wants us to believe, it should be a simple matter to find material proof of his visit to General Acha or to Bahia Blanca in May 1950.

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Sail along, silvery disc: a response

I read with appreciation and some dismay Hobart Gregory Baker's commentary, in the last issue of *IUR*, on the Alaska close encounter case I discussed in November/December 1984 *IUR*. Baker claims that the "close encounter" was not with a UFO but with the moon.

Of course Baker is quite correct in pointing out the continuing need for good research in the field of UFO investigation (or, for that matter, any other endeavor worthy of our attention). But then, having lectured us roundly on the fundamentals of good investigatory practice, he goes on to commit the scientifically unacceptable action of rewriting the case to fit his own theory.

He alters the color-change sequence reported by the two witnesses to the exact opposite of what they said it was. He demands the existence of trees and mountains where necessary to fit his thesis when no such impediments to vision existed. He claims that the witnesses were unable to tell in which direction the object moved. He alleges that it moved *west*, hence necessitating that it move up and more or less overhead when in fact the witnesses report that it moved up a ridge and to the *north* until out of sight (following the country, i.e., the terrain). He ignores the witnesses' testimony that the object remained both stationary and silver-colored for a considerable period of time before it began its dramatic color-change sequence. It did not begin to change from silver to yellow to orange until well into the next hour from the time it appeared.

Baker further demands that the witnesses were capable of mistaking the apparent size of the rising moon by a 25-fold factor. He ignores the witnesses' assertion that the object not only was silver-colored but resembled a huge geodesic dome. There is nothing in this that even vaguely suggests the rising full moon.

I believe that I can rule out the moon according to the data given in the article (whatever other information there may be being irrelevant). I do not believe Baker can rule the moon in according to those same data -- which is

why, I assume, he changed the data to suit his thesis.

Now, as to the quality of my investigation:

I interviewed the woman witness by long-distance telephone on two occasions prior to her writing her letter, taking notes in each instance. Upon receiving her letter I prepared a set of questions and spoke with her again.

I had also separately queried her husband on two occasions long before I talked with her. This gave me the ability to judge the clarity of her recall of the event -- she having detailed to him the full sequence of events that occurred during the experience soon after her return to Idaho from Alaska.

I have also interviewed the woman's father who was the other witness to the event. His remarks, fully corroborating her testimony, form part of the log of this case.

Finally, a few observations about the witnesses:

Bonnie McCrorey and her father Maurice Smith are Western ranch people. Smith, in his 60s, still runs 500 head of cattle and several thousand sheep. The high plains, hills and mountains are the home environment of these people. The moon in any of its aspects or phases is no stranger to Smith or his 35-year-old daughter. Dusk and the rising moon (however resplendent) and dawn and the rising sun are facts of everyday life. We are not, in other words, dealing with city-bred tourists on their yearly outing, in a rare confrontation with nature.

Simply put, the facts of the case do not permit the moon to be a reasonable explanation for what the observers saw. -- *Richard Sigismond*